

INVESTMENT READINESS REPORT

PlacementOS

AI-Powered Placement Prep Platform for Indian Engineering Students — Business Strategy & Sustainability Assessment

PREPARED FOR	Founder Review / Demonstration Exercise
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SOURCE DOCUMENT	Day 23 Customer & MVP Blueprint
STAGE	Pre-Build / Idea Validation
MARKET	India — NCR / UP Tier-2/3 Engineering Colleges → Pan-India
DATE	28 June 2026

- EdTech
- AI / LLM-Assisted
- B2C Freemium
- India Tier-2/3

This report stress-tests the Day 23 Blueprint as an unvalidated hypothesis set — not a confirmed business. All scores and recommendations are directional, built from category reasoning and market pattern-matching, not from real customer or revenue data. Treat this as a pre-flight check before week 1 of building.

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SECTION 1 Startup Summary & Assumption Extraction

A condensed read of the Day 23 Blueprint, followed by the explicit and implicit assumptions this business depends on.

Startup in 8 Bullets

- **What it is:** An AI-assisted placement-prep platform for engineering students at Tier-2/3 Indian colleges — starting with a resume gap-analyzer and a personalized 8-week prep roadmap.
- **Who it's for:** 2nd–4th year B.Tech CS/IT/ECE students at non-IIT/NIT, state-affiliated colleges (AKTU and similar), mobile-first, price-sensitive.
- **The pain:** Prep is fragmented across YouTube, generic paid bootcamps, and informal senior advice — none of it personalized to the student's actual skill gaps or target company tier.
- **The wedge (MVP):** Upload resume + pick target role/company tier → get a skill-gap report → get a sequenced 8-week roadmap → track progress.
- **Business model:** Freemium. Free gap-analysis as a lead magnet; one-time paid unlock (₹299–₹499) for the full roadmap and tracking, with optional add-ons (₹199–₹299).
- **Distribution thesis:** Peer proof and placement-season urgency drive discovery — seniors' LinkedIn posts, WhatsApp/Telegram college groups, and resume-rejection moments are the trigger points.
- **Validation status:** Zero direct customer validation has been run. Every pricing, demand, and channel assumption below is a hypothesis, not a confirmed fact.
- **Stated next step (from the blueprint itself):** Run 15–20 customer interviews and a fake-door pricing test in Week 1 — before writing product code.

Extracted Assumptions

Dimension	Stated Assumption
Customer	Tier-2/3 B.Tech students (CS/IT/ECE), 2nd–4th year, who already spend ₹500–₹5,000/year across scattered prep resources and feel "behind" their CP/DSEA-strong peers. Buying decision is individual (student), not institutional.
MVP	A rules-engine-first (not AI-first) resume gap-analyzer plus an 8-week roadmap generator and progress dashboard. Explicitly excludes mock-interview AI, proctored testing, and native app in v1.
Value Proposition	Personalization and time-saved versus free YouTube content — "tells you exactly what's missing and what to do next," not "more content than what's already free."
Pricing	One-time fee per placement cycle (₹299–₹499), explicitly avoiding subscription billing because the use case is single-season, not recurring. Add-ons priced ₹199–₹299.
Revenue	Implied model: free-to-paid conversion off a gap-analysis lead magnet, plus a secondary upsell layer (mock interview / premium DSA tracks). No conversion rate, CAC, or LTV figures are estimated anywhere in the source document.
GTM	Organic, peer-network-led distribution — college WhatsApp/Telegram groups, placed-senior testimonials, and placement-season timing — with no paid acquisition channel specified.

Why this matters

The blueprint is unusually honest about its own immaturity — it scores MVP Readiness at only 45/100 and explicitly labels itself a hypothesis set. That candor is a strength for planning, but it also means every number below (pricing, conversion, CAC) is a guess dressed in currency symbols, not a forecast.

SECTION 2 Business Reality Check

Stripping the idea down to the questions that actually determine whether money will move.

Who pays?

The student pays — not the college, not a recruiter, not a parent directly (though parents may be the actual card-holder for a ₹299-₹499 transaction). This is a **B2C, individual, discretionary-spend** purchase made by someone with little or no independent income. That is a materially harder buyer than a salaried professional or an institution with a training budget.

Why do they pay?

The blueprint's answer is "personalization and time saved," validated only by the precedent that students already pay for DSA courses, resume reviews, and mock-interview packages *separately*. That's a real signal — but it's evidence that students pay for **specific, narrow services**, not evidence that they'll pay for a bundled diagnostic-plus-roadmap product from an unknown, unproven brand with zero placed-student track record.

How will they discover the product?

Entirely organic and peer-dependent: senior testimonials, WhatsApp/Telegram group drops, and placement-season urgency. There is no paid channel, no SEO/content engine, and no institutional partnership (college placement cells) in the plan. This is the single highest-risk gap in the blueprint — distribution is assumed to "just happen" through peer trust, but peer trust has to be earned first, which requires the outcome proof the product doesn't have yet.

Biggest growth risks

- **Cold-start trust problem:** the core objection — "I don't trust an AI to know what recruiters want" — can only be resolved with placed-student proof, which doesn't exist until after the first cohort succeeds. This is a chicken-and-egg loop.
- **Seasonality:** placement cycles create a hard demand window (roughly Aug-Dec and Jan-Mar in most AKTU-affiliated colleges); growth outside that window will be near zero unless an off-season hook is built.
- **Channel concentration:** WhatsApp/Telegram group drops are low-cost but low-scale and easily ignored — group admins and members see dozens of these "tool" posts per season.

Biggest monetization risks

- **Willingness-to-pay before outcome is delivered:** students are asked to pay ₹299-₹499 *before* placements happen, when their budget anxiety is highest and the product has no track record. "I don't have money to spend before I have a job" is listed as an objection but not yet resolved with a concrete answer.
- **One-time pricing ceiling:** a one-time ₹299-₹499 fee per student per cycle caps lifetime value hard. At scale this requires very high volume, not deep monetization per user, to build a real revenue base.
- **Free tier cannibalization:** if the free gap-analysis report already delivers the "aha, I see my problem" moment, some meaningful share of users may feel satisfied enough to leave and self-execute (e.g., copy the gap list and go follow free YouTube playlists), never converting.

Weakest assumptions to validate first

1. **"Personalization beats free content" is unproven.** Until a real student says this out loud unprompted, it's a guess about what differentiates the product.
2. **Price point (₹299-₹499) has no anchor.** It "feels" low-friction but hasn't been tested against an actual fake-door page — the blueprint itself flags this.
3. **One-time vs. recurring revenue logic is asserted, not tested.** It's plausible students reject subscriptions, but it's equally plausible a freemium subscription with monthly check-ins would retain better across a multi-month prep window.
4. **Distribution-by-peer-trust assumes virality that hasn't been observed.** No comparable case study or pilot data is cited for how fast or how far a WhatsApp-group drop actually spreads in this demographic.

Reality check verdict

This is a well-articulated problem statement riding on an unproven distribution and monetization engine. The product itself (resume gap-analyzer + roadmap) is buildable in weeks. The harder, unsolved problem is convincing a budget-anxious 20-year-old to pay an unknown brand before there's any visible proof it works — and the blueprint correctly identifies this as the Week 1 priority, not a Week 4 afterthought.

SECTION 3

Executive Summary

PlacementOS targets a real and widely felt pain point: Tier-2/3 engineering students lack a personalized system for placement prep, relying instead on fragmented free content, generic paid bootcamps, and informal peer advice. The proposed MVP — a resume gap-analyzer paired with a sequenced 8-week roadmap — is a smart, low-build-cost wedge that avoids the trap of building expensive AI mock-interview or proctoring infrastructure before demand is proven.

The core strategic risk is not the product; it's the **go-to-market and trust loop**. The buyer is a budget-constrained student who must pay before seeing any outcome, from a brand with zero placed-student proof, discovered only through peer channels that themselves require trust to work. Distribution and monetization are tightly coupled here in a way the blueprint doesn't fully resolve: the thing that unlocks distribution (placed-student testimonials) doesn't exist until paying customers already exist.

Financially, the one-time ₹299–₹499 pricing model is rational for a single-season-use product but caps per-user revenue hard, meaning this only becomes a sustainable business at meaningful volume (thousands of paying students per cycle) or with a second revenue layer beyond the individual B2C transaction — most plausibly a B2B2C layer (colleges, coaching centers, or training partners) that the current blueprint does not yet explore.

Verdict Category	Read
Problem-Market Fit	Strong. The pain is specific, recurring, and well-documented across the persona research.
Solution Fit	Plausible but unproven. Personalization claim has not been tested with real students.
Monetization	Fragile. Low ceiling per user; pre-outcome payment friction; no validated price point.
Distribution	Weakest link. Entirely organic, peer-trust-dependent, with a cold-start chicken-and-egg problem.
Overall stage	Promising hypothesis. Correctly classified by the source document as pre-validation, not pre-launch.

SECTION 4.1 Business Model Canvas

Block	Detail
Customer Segments	Primary: 2nd–4th year B.Tech CS/IT/ECE students at Tier-2/3, non-IIT/NIT colleges (NCR/UP belt first). Secondary (future): coaching centers and college placement cells as a distribution layer.
Value Proposition	"Know exactly what's wrong with your resume and exactly what to do for the next 8 weeks" — personalized diagnosis plus a sequenced plan, replacing directionless self-prep across scattered free resources.
Channels	College WhatsApp/Telegram groups, peer/senior LinkedIn and Instagram posts, word-of-mouth at placement-season onset. No paid or institutional channel currently planned.
Customer Relationships	Largely self-serve and asynchronous; trust built through visible progress markers and (eventually) placed-student proof rather than human support.
Revenue Streams	(1) One-time freemium unlock ₹299–₹499 per placement cycle; (2) optional add-ons ₹199–₹299 (mock interview module, premium DSA tracks). No recurring/subscription stream in v1.
Key Resources	Resume-scoring rubric/logic, curated (not authored) DSA and aptitude content, roadmap-generation engine, and — critically — a credible bank of placed-student outcomes once available.
Key Activities	Building and refining the gap-analysis rubric, curating external content rather than producing it, running interview/validation cycles, and securing testimonial proof points.
Key Partnerships	Not yet defined in the blueprint. Highest-leverage gap: placed seniors (for proof), and potentially college placement cells (for distribution, positioned as a complement, not a replacement).
Cost Structure	Low at MVP stage — rules-engine + LLM-assisted scoring, curated content (not original), no native app, no proctoring infra. Main future costs: LLM API usage at scale, and customer acquisition once organic channels saturate.

Canvas gap to flag

Key Partnerships is the emptiest block in this canvas. A B2C-only, peer-trust-only model is the slowest possible way to reach scale in a seasonal market. The single highest-leverage addition to this canvas would be a placement-cell or coaching-center partnership channel — explored further in Section 4.4.

SECTION 4.2

Revenue & Pricing Strategy

Pricing Model Assessment

The blueprint's instinct to avoid subscription billing for a single-season-use product is sound — a recurring charge on a budget-anxious student with no income is a needless point of friction and churn. But "one-time fee" creates its own structural ceiling: there's no way to extract more value from a satisfied user within the same cycle beyond the ₹199–₹299 add-on layer.

Tier	What's Included	Price (Hypothesis)
Free	Resume upload + skill-gap report (lead magnet)	₹0
Core Unlock	Full 8-week roadmap, target role/company selector, progress dashboard	₹299–₹499 one-time
Add-ons	Mock-interview module (text-based), premium DSA tracks	₹199–₹299 each

Revenue Math — Reality Check (Illustrative, Not Forecast)

Using the blueprint's own price band and a deliberately conservative funnel, to show what volume is actually required:

Scenario	Assumptions	Cycle Revenue (Illustrative)
Conservative	2,000 free users → 5% convert at ₹349	~₹35,000
Base case	10,000 free users → 8% convert at ₹399	~₹3,19,000
Optimistic	50,000 free users → 12% convert at ₹449 + 20% of payers buy one add-on (₹249)	~₹26,94,000 + ₹14,94,000 add-on ≈ ₹41,88,000

These are illustrative funnel math, not projections — every input (conversion %, free-user volume) is currently an assumption with zero supporting data.

The real takeaway

At this price point, the business only becomes financially meaningful at five-figure-plus free-user volume per cycle. That makes **distribution efficiency**, not pricing optimization, the single most important lever in this entire model. A perfect product with a small audience produces a hobby, not a business.

Pricing Recommendations

- Run the fake-door test exactly as planned — but test two price points (e.g., ₹299 vs ₹499) against two different audiences to get real elasticity data, not just a single conversion number.
- Consider a small non-refundable "commitment fee" (e.g., ₹49) ahead of the full unlock, to de-risk the all-or-nothing ₹299–₹499 jump and create a lower-friction first transaction.
- Explore a B2B2C pricing layer in parallel — selling a college/coaching-center license (bulk seats) is a second revenue stream that doesn't depend on individual willingness-to-pay psychology.

GTM Sequencing

Phase	Focus
Phase 0 (Pre-launch)	15–20 customer interviews, fake-door landing page, price-point testing. Goal: confirm pain severity and willingness-to-pay before any build.
Phase 1 (Seed cohort)	Onboard 20–30 beta users from 1–2 colleges (founder’s own network). Goal: working product feedback loop, not revenue.
Phase 2 (Proof creation)	Convert 2–3 beta users into visible placed-student testimonials. This is the unlock for every later distribution channel — without it, peer trust cannot form.
Phase 3 (Peer-network scale)	Push testimonial-backed content into 10–15 college WhatsApp/Telegram groups and LinkedIn, timed to placement-season announcements.
Phase 4 (Channel diversification)	Only after organic peer growth plateaus: explore placement-cell partnerships, coaching-center referral deals, and paid micro-budget tests (Instagram/YouTube Shorts targeting engineering-student audiences).

Why Sequencing Matters Here

The single biggest GTM mistake this business could make is skipping straight to Phase 3 broadcast tactics before Phase 2 proof exists. A WhatsApp group post that says "try our AI tool" with no placed-student backing will get the exact objection the blueprint already identified: *"I don't trust an AI to know what recruiters want."* Proof must come before broadcast, not alongside it.

Off-season risk reminder

Because demand is seasonal, GTM activity outside placement windows should focus on building the proof bank (testimonials, case studies, rubric credibility) and seeding early-year (1st/2nd year) awareness — not on acquisition spend, which will underperform against the calendar.

SECTION 4.4

Customer Acquisition Strategy

Primary Channels (Ranked by Expected Efficiency)

Channel	Mechanism	Constraint
Placed-senior testimonials	Direct peer credibility transfer; highest trust-per-impression of any channel available	Requires Phase 2 proof to exist first; cannot be rushed
College WhatsApp/Telegram groups	Low-cost, high-relevance distribution directly inside the target ICP's daily information flow	Easily ignored without proof; admins may treat as spam
LinkedIn "100 days of prep" trend-riding	Piggyback on an existing peer behavior (progress-posting) already shown to trigger comparison anxiety in the ICP	Requires founder or early users to actively post — needs a content nudge/template
Placement-cell partnership	Institutional channel reaching an entire cohort at once; positioned as a complement, not competitor, to the cell	Slow sales cycle, requires credibility PlacementOS won't have at launch
Coaching-center referral	Centers already have trust + distribution; could bundle PlacementOS as a value-add	Margin-sharing or partnership terms need negotiation; unexplored in blueprint

CAC Reality Check

Every currently-planned channel is organic/zero-spend, which is appropriate at this stage but not infinitely scalable. The real CAC question this business will face in 6–12 months is whether organic peer growth alone can fill a placement season's demand window, or whether a small paid layer (campus ambassadors, micro-influencer engineering students, hyper-targeted Instagram Reels) becomes necessary once the free network effect plateaus.

Low-cost lever worth testing early

A "campus ambassador" model — paying or rewarding 1–2 students per college with free premium access or a small referral bonus for onboarding their batch — could meaningfully compress the cold-start trust problem at near-zero cash cost.

SECTION 4.5 First 100 Users Plan

Users	Source	Action
1-20	Founder's direct network	Personal outreach to classmates/seniors; manual onboarding; founder personally reviews each gap report for quality before it ships, to catch rubric errors early
21-50	1-2 college beta cohort	Recruit via the Week 4 beta plan already specified in the blueprint; collect verbatim qualitative feedback on every session
51-70	Testimonial-driven referrals	Once 2-3 placed-student (or "successfully on-track") stories exist, ask those users to share directly in their own batch group — not a generic broadcast
71-100	Targeted WhatsApp/Telegram drops	Post in 3-5 relevant groups (as the blueprint specifies) <i>only</i> once testimonial proof is attached to the post — never post the tool "cold"

Success Gate Before Scaling Past 100

- At least 40% of the first 100 complete onboarding through to seeing their gap report (activation).
- At least 20% return within 7 days to check roadmap progress (early retention signal).
- At least 2-3 users describe the product as "personalized" or equivalent **unprompted** in feedback — the blueprint's own qualitative success metric, and the right one to hold the line on before spending on broader distribution.

Discipline check

If these gates aren't met at 100 users, the right move is to fix the product or reposition the value prop — not to push the same unproven funnel into more WhatsApp groups. Scaling a leaky funnel just produces a bigger leak.

SECTION 4.6

Competitive Position & Moat

Competitive Landscape

Competitor Type	Strength	Weakness vs. PlacementOS
Free YouTube/content creators	Zero cost, huge volume, high trust for specific creators	No personalization, no structure, no progress tracking
Paid bootcamps (₹15k+)	Structured curriculum, brand recognition, sometimes placement guarantees	Priced out of this ICP's budget; generic, not gap-specific
LeetCode/coding platforms	Deep DSA practice, strong brand among CP-focused students	DSA-only; no resume, aptitude, or roadmap layer
College placement cells	Institutional trust, free to student, direct recruiter access	Generic, one-size-fits-all, not personalized to individual gaps

Where the Moat Actually Comes From

PlacementOS has **no defensible moat at MVP stage** — a rules-engine resume scorer and an LLM-assisted roadmap generator are not hard to replicate. The real, earnable moat is not technical; it's the accumulation of three things over time:

- **Proof density:** a growing, visible bank of placed-student outcomes tied to specific colleges and target companies — this is what the "trust gap" objection actually requires, and it compounds with every cohort.
- **Rubric quality:** the accuracy of "what recruiters actually screen for" at specific company tiers, refined through real outcome data over multiple placement cycles — a data moat that a copycat starting from zero can't shortcut.
- **Peer-network embedding:** if PlacementOS becomes the thing seniors recommend by default in a specific college or region, that habit is sticky and hard for a new entrant to dislodge without equivalent proof.

Honest framing

None of this moat exists yet. It has to be earned through 2–3 successful placement cycles before it becomes real. Until then, the only protection is speed of execution and first-mover relationship-building within specific colleges.

SECTION 4.7

Reverse SWOT Analysis

A reverse SWOT interrogates each quadrant for the failure mode hiding inside it, rather than just listing the positive framing.

Quadrant	The Hidden Risk Inside It
Strength → Problem clarity	A sharply defined problem can create false confidence. Knowing the pain exists is not the same as knowing students will pay an unknown brand to solve it before an outcome is proven.
Weakness → Zero validation	Worse than just "early stage": every downstream number in this report (pricing, conversion, CAC) inherits the uncertainty of an unvalidated core assumption. A wrong assumption at the foundation invalidates everything built on top of it.
Opportunity → Large addressable market	Millions of students is a vanity framing if distribution can't reach them efficiently. A large TAM with no scalable channel is not an opportunity yet — it's a market size statistic.
Threat → Free alternatives	The deeper threat isn't that free content exists — it's that free content is "good enough" for the most price-sensitive, motivated segment of the ICP, leaving PlacementOS to fight for the smaller segment willing to pay for convenience, which may be too small to sustain the business.

Investor One-Liner

One-liner

"PlacementOS turns placement prep from a guessing game into a personalized roadmap — starting with a resume gap-analyzer for India's millions of Tier-2/3 engineering students who currently have no system, just scattered content and anxiety."

30-Second Founder Pitch

"Every placement season, millions of Tier-2/3 engineering students prep the same way — random YouTube playlists, a few mock interviews if they're lucky, and a resume nobody's actually checked against what recruiters screen for. They don't know if they're on track, and they find out too late that they weren't. PlacementOS fixes the first, highest-leverage step: upload your resume, tell us your target role, and get a clear gap report plus an 8-week plan built around what's actually missing — not more content, just the right content in the right order. We're starting with a free gap-analysis as the entry point and a low one-time unlock for the full roadmap, because these students can't and won't pay a subscription before they have a job. The real question we're testing right now isn't whether the problem is real — it clearly is — it's whether peer trust and outcome proof can drive distribution fast enough to make this a business, not just a useful tool."

Why this framing works for investors

It leads with the problem's severity, names the actual open risk honestly (distribution, not product), and signals founder self-awareness about validation stage — which reads as credibility, not weakness, to an experienced early-stage investor.

SECTION 5

Investment Scorecard

Scored 0–100 on revenue and distribution discipline, not idea novelty. All scores are directional, based on the blueprint's content and category pattern-matching — not on real customer or financial data.

52	40	35	38	45
BUSINESS VIABILITY	REVENUE POTENTIAL	GTM STRENGTH	COMPETITIVE STRENGTH	INVESTOR READINESS

Dimension	Score	Reasoning
Business Viability	52/100	Real, well-documented pain point and a buildable, low-cost MVP. Held back by an entirely unvalidated revenue and distribution loop — viable in concept, unproven in practice.
Revenue Potential	40/100	One-time, low-rupee pricing caps per-user value hard; needs large volume or a second (B2B2C) revenue layer to become meaningful. No conversion or CAC data exists yet to support any forecast.
GTM Strength	35/100	Entirely organic and peer-trust-dependent with a real cold-start chicken-and-egg problem (proof needed for trust, trust needed for distribution, distribution needed for proof). No paid or institutional channel yet.
Competitive Strength	38/100	No technical moat at MVP stage; differentiation depends entirely on execution quality (rubric accuracy, proof density) that takes multiple cycles to build and currently doesn't exist.
Investor Readiness	45/100	Strong problem articulation and honest self-scoring work in its favor; the complete absence of any customer interview, waitlist, or fake-door data is the single biggest gap before this is fundable.

Composite read

Average score $\approx$ **42/100** — consistent with a "Validate" stage idea: real problem, plausible solution, but not yet supported by evidence on the two things that actually decide sustainability — distribution and willingness-to-pay.

A single-glance view of the business model, revenue range, GTM sequencing, first 100 users plan, moat status, key risks, scorecard, and final verdict.

INVESTMENT READINESS — VISUAL DASHBOARD

PlacementOS

AI-Powered Placement Prep Platform · Pre-Build / Validation Stage

Business Model

Freemium → one-time unlock

Student discovers via peer/WhatsApp/LinkedIn

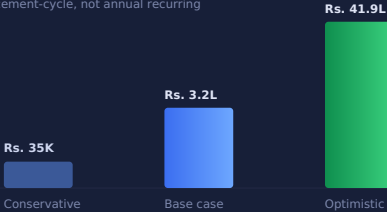
Uploads resume → Free gap-analysis report

Converts → Rs. 299-499 full roadmap unlock

Optional add-on: Rs. 199-299

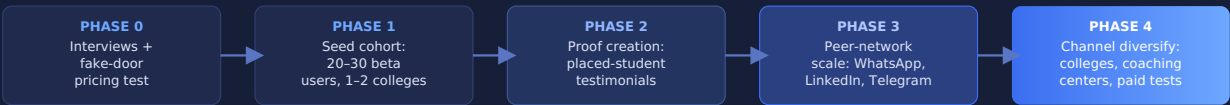
Revenue Streams (Illustrative)

Per-placement-cycle, not annual recurring



Go-To-Market Flow

Proof must precede broadcast — sequencing is the whole strategy



First 100 Users Plan

1-20 · Founder's direct network

21-50 · 1-2 college beta cohort

51-70 · Testimonial-driven referrals

71-100 · Targeted group drops (proof-backed)

Gate before scaling: ≥40% activation, ≥20% 7-day return, 2-3 unprompted "personalized" mentions.

Competitive Moat — Status

No technical moat at MVP. Moat is earned, not built.

- Technical moat: **none today**
- Proof density (placed-student bank): **building**
- Rubric accuracy (recruiter-validated): **unproven**
- Peer-network embedding: **earnable over 2-3 cycles**

Defensibility timeline: realistically 2-3 placement cycles before any of the above becomes a real moat.

Key Risks

Cold-start trust loop

Proof needs payers; payers need proof. Highest-severity risk in the whole model.

Seasonal demand

Placement cycles = hard demand windows. Off-season growth near zero without a retention hook.

Pre-outcome payment

Budget-anxious students must pay before any result is visible — unresolved in the current plan.

Investment Scorecard

Directional scores from category reasoning — no real customer data yet

52

BUSINESS VIABILITY

40

REVENUE POTENTIAL

35

GTМ STRENGTH

38

COMPETITIVE STRENGTH

45

INVESTOR READINESS

Composite Score

42 / 100

FINAL VERDICT

VALIDATE

Real problem. Plausible solution. Unproven distribution and willingness-to-pay.

The product is buildable in weeks. The business depends on whether peer-trust distribution and pre-outcome payment psychology actually work — and that is untested. Run Week 1 interviews and the fake-door pricing test before building.

☒ Investable ☒ **Validate (current stage)** ☐ Pivot ☐ Reject

Scores are directional estimates from category reasoning, not validated customer/financial data.

SECTION 7

Founder Action Sheet — Top 10 Actions

Sequenced for the next 30 days. Each action is chosen to retire a specific assumption flagged in Sections 1–2, not just to "make progress."

#	Action
1	Draft a 10-question customer interview script targeting placement-prep pain severity and willingness-to-pay — not feature wishlists.
2	Recruit 15–20 students from your own college network for interviews this week. Prioritize a mix of "anxious mid-prep" and "already rejected once" students.
3	Build a 1-page fake-door landing site with the value prop and a "Join Waitlist / Pay Rs. 299" button — test two price points across two audiences if possible.
4	Post the landing page in 3–5 relevant college WhatsApp/Telegram groups to gauge organic interest and click-through, before any product exists.
5	Define the exact resume-gap-analysis rubric — what signals actually matter for Tier-2/3 student resumes at the target company tiers.
6	Build the roadmap-generation logic as a simple rules engine first; defer LLM/AI complexity until the rules-based version is validated.
7	Identify and lock in 2–3 placed seniors willing to validate the rubric and give a testimonial — this is the single highest-leverage trust unlock in the whole plan.
8	Set up basic analytics (sign-ups, activation rate, 7-day return) before any public launch, so Week 4 beta data is actually measurable.
9	Run the first 20-user beta cohort and document qualitative feedback verbatim — specifically listening for unprompted use of the word "personalized."
10	Revisit the Rs. 299–499 pricing hypothesis using real fake-door conversion data, not assumption — and explore a parallel B2B2C (college/coaching-center) pricing test if individual conversion looks weak.

North star for the next 30 days

Don't write product code until items 1–4 produce real signal. The blueprint already gets this right — the discipline now is following through on it rather than skipping ahead to building because building feels like progress.

VALIDATE

PlacementOS addresses a real, sharply felt pain point with a sensibly scoped MVP, but it is not yet a sustainable business — it is a well-reasoned hypothesis with zero customer validation behind its two most important assumptions: that students will pay before seeing an outcome, and that peer-trust distribution can reach scale fast enough to matter within a seasonal demand window. Revenue math only works at meaningful volume given the one-time, low-rupee pricing model, which makes distribution efficiency — not product polish — the deciding factor for whether this becomes a real business or stays a useful side project.

The path forward is exactly the one the original blueprint already prescribes: run the Week 1 interviews and fake-door pricing test, secure 2–3 placed-student proof points before any broadcast distribution, and treat the first 100 users as a gate to pass — not a number to hit. If those signals come back strong, this moves cleanly from **Validate** to **Investable**; if they don't, the team will have spent 30 days and near-zero capital finding that out, which is the entire point of doing this in the right order.

This report is a structured analysis of a self-generated demonstration blueprint, not a confirmed startup with real financial or customer data. Re-run this analysis once real interview, waitlist, or fake-door data exists for an updated, evidence-backed verdict.